

IT'S HAMMER TIME!

Fixing your tech woes is not as hard as you might imagine. Here are a handful of quick-fixes that will give you some much needed relief without leaving much of a dent in your wallet.

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QUICK FIXES

Streaming Audio

We all know just how much we hate wires and all that clutter that accompanies it. But what if you could change all that and enjoy the pleasures of the analogue world with the wireless comfort of the digital one?



It's quite easy really. You just need to get yourself a Bluetooth audio streamer (around ₹1,000) and attach it to any device that you want to stream your audio to. It's that simple. Buy the device, pair it with your phone or iPod or whatever and attach it to your amp or other output device (usually via a 3.5mm jack) and stream audio to the device as you would to any other Bluetooth headset. Voila! You can now stream your music wirelessly to any corner of the house, just as long as you are within range that is.

What was that?

If you're perpetually straining to make out what your phone is trying to stream to

your fancy pair of headphones, maybe it's time you got yourself a headphone amp. These amps can be as small or as large as you want, ditto the price.

If all you're really interested in is boosted volume, a simple amp that costs around ₹1,000 should be fine. It'll boost the volume and should be powerful enough to drive most headphones just shy of ridiculously high impedance sets such as the Sennheiser HD800.

It's important to note that a headphone amp is not going to dramatically improve the audio quality that's coming out of your source (in this case, let's assume that it's your phone). The amp will only boost volume, absolutely nothing else. Also remember that some amps are exception-



ally powerful and if you boost the volume too high, there's a good chance that you'll damage not only your headset, but also your ear drums as well.

No audio? No problem.

It's quite common for older PCs, particularly laptops, to suffer from audio issues. Either the 3.5 mm jacks get rusted or something breaks or even a circuit might get fried. The solution, again, is quite simple. You can pick up a USB sound card for as little as ₹600 and partake of the joys of audio once again.



Spend a little more and get a good quality USB audio card for a better experience. The audio quality from these sound cards is usually way better than your motherboard's onboard audio solution and that should be enough for most users.

Let there be light

Playing games or watching movies in the middle of the night can be a strain on the eyes, especially if you play with the lights off. And what if you don't have a backlit keyboard? Get yourself a simple USB LED lamp (they're available for as little as ₹100) and a cheap USB extension cable. Or you can also pick up USB-powered LED strips and attach them to the back of your TV, which, by the way, will usually